

COMSATS Abbottabad

Department of Software Engineering

Business Process Engineering (BPE)

Assignment #1 — Business Process Architecture

Case Study:

Palantir Technologies Inc.

Submitted By:

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1. Problem Statement

Palantir Technologies is a US-based software company that builds powerful data and AI platforms for governments, military organizations, and large companies. Its main products — Gotham, Foundry, Apollo, and AIP — are used by clients in over 20 countries.

Palantir serves many very different types of customers at the same time. But it has no clearly documented Business Process Architecture (BPA) that maps how all its processes connect — from strategy at the top to daily operations and internal support. Without this, teams may work in disconnected ways, causing wasted effort and poor service.

This assignment builds a complete BPA for Palantir — covering its vision, goals, case types, business functions, process architecture, and process matrix.

2. Introduction

Palantir Technologies Inc. was founded in 2003 and is headquartered in Denver, Colorado, USA. It is named after the all-seeing stones in Lord of the Rings — because its software is designed to find hidden patterns in large, complex data.

Key facts:

Founded: 2003

Headquarters: Denver, Colorado, U.S.

CEO: Alexander Karp

Ticker symbol: PLTR (Nasdaq)

Market capitalization: about \$430 billion (Dec 2025)

Core platforms:

Palantir has four main platforms.

1. **Gotham** is used by governments and militaries to analyze threats and plan operations.
2. **Foundry** is used by commercial companies to manage and understand their data.
3. **Apollo** is the system that delivers and updates all Palantir software anywhere in the world without downtime.
4. **AIP (Artificial Intelligence Platform)**, launched in 2023, adds secure AI and large language models to Foundry and Gotham.

In 2024, Palantir earned \$2.87 billion in revenue — \$1.57 billion from governments and \$1.30 billion from commercial clients. It operates across North America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, and the Middle East. This document presents a full Business Process Architecture for Palantir.

3. Vision

"To be the most important technology company in the world — one that helps governments and businesses use their data to make better, faster, and more responsible decisions."

Palantir's vision is built on four key ideas:

1. **Data is the Most Valuable Asset:** Palantir's entire work is about turning messy, disconnected data into clear, useful information that helps leaders decide what to do next.
2. **Technology for Important Missions:** Palantir focuses on missions that really matter — protecting countries, saving lives, and keeping supply chains running. Every product is built for these big goals.
3. **Responsible AI:** Palantir's AIP platform is built so that AI is always under human control, decisions can be explained, and sensitive data stays safe and private.
4. **Long-Term Customer Partnerships:** Palantir sends its own engineers — called Forward Deployed Engineers (FDEs) — directly into client organizations to make sure the software actually works and delivers results.

4. Main Goals

The following 17 goals define what Palantir wants to achieve through its Business Process Architecture:

1. Build a clear Business Process Architecture that maps every key process in Palantir, from product delivery to internal support.
2. Keep improving the Gotham platform so government clients can analyze threats and plan missions faster and more accurately.
3. Expand Foundry into new industries — healthcare, energy, finance, and manufacturing — so more commercial clients can use it.
4. Grow AIP as the safest and most practical way for large organizations to use AI in real, day-to-day operations.
5. Deliver Apollo to more clients so they can run Palantir software anywhere — cloud, on-site, or classified networks — without downtime.
6. Scale the AIP Bootcamp program so new customers get working AI results within days, not months.
7. Grow US commercial revenue by helping mid-size and large businesses that need AI-powered data tools.
8. Keep existing government contracts and win new ones in defense, intelligence, and public health sectors.
9. Build a world-class HR process to hire and keep the best engineers, data scientists, and business staff.
10. Build a Developer and Partner Ecosystem so third-party companies can build on top of Palantir platforms.

11. Make sure all customer systems are secure and comply with local laws and cybersecurity standards.
12. Improve client onboarding so new customers get their first use cases up and running as fast as possible.
13. Set up a performance monitoring process so leaders can track how well each product and team is doing.
14. Create a clear procurement process to manage all cloud providers and third-party vendors Palantir depends on.
15. Make Palantir's marketing clearer so more businesses understand what it does and why it is different.
16. Add ethical AI and sustainability practices into all business processes so Palantir stays responsible.
17. Manage all R&D projects and strategic investments through a Project Portfolio Management process.

5. Case Types Identified

A case type is a category of customer or situation that the organization serves. Palantir serves six case types:

Case Type 1 — Government and Defense Customers

National governments, military forces, and intelligence agencies that use Palantir Gotham. Examples include the US Department of Defense and allied nation defense departments. They need highly secure environments, real-time threat analysis, and data fusion from thousands of sources.

Case Type 2 — Commercial Enterprise Customers

Large private companies that use Palantir Foundry to improve operations. Examples include Airbus, BP, and Merck. They need data integration, custom workflow apps, and ongoing engineering support to grow their use of the platform.

Case Type 3 — AI and AIP Customers

Organizations that use Palantir AIP to add AI into their operations. They attend 5-day Bootcamp sessions and get hands-on support to build AI workflows for use cases like factory automation, hospital operations, or military decision-making.

Case Type 4 — Developer and Partner Ecosystem

Independent software developers and system integrators who build apps on top of Palantir platforms. Palantir gives them APIs, tools, and certifications so they can create and sell their own solutions built on Foundry and AIP.

Case Type 5 — Healthcare and Life Sciences Customers

Hospitals, pharmaceutical companies, and public health agencies with strict privacy rules (like HIPAA and GDPR). They use Palantir to manage patient data, run clinical trials, track drug supply chains, and respond to health emergencies.

Case Type 6 — Internal Customers (Employees and Departments)

Palantir's own staff — engineers, Forward Deployed Engineers, HR, finance, legal, and marketing teams. They are served by internal support processes. Their satisfaction directly affects the quality of what Palantir delivers to clients.

6. Business Functions Against Case Types

Below are 48 business functions of Palantir, grouped by the case type they serve:

6.1 Government and Defense Customers

1. **Gotham Platform Deployment** — Setting up and customizing Gotham for government clients in secure, classified environments.
2. **Intelligence Data Fusion** — Connecting data from satellite feeds, signals, and reports into one clear view.
3. **Mission Planning Support** — Helping defense clients plan and run operations using Gotham tools.
4. **Government Contract Management** — Managing proposals, awards, renewals, and compliance for all government contracts.
5. **Classified Network Deployment** — Running Palantir software in classified government networks with all required security certifications.

6. **Defense Customer Training** — Teaching military and intelligence analysts how to use Gotham through workshops and on-site support.
7. **Government Compliance Reporting** — Preparing all regulatory reports required by defense contracts (e.g., FedRAMP, ITAR).

6.2 Commercial Enterprise Customers

1. **Foundry Platform Deployment** — Setting up Foundry for commercial clients based on their data, workflows, and goals.
2. **Data Pipeline Management** — Building and maintaining data pipelines that bring raw client data into Foundry and keep it clean.
3. **Ontology and Data Model Development** — Building digital models inside Foundry that represent a client's key business objects.
4. **Custom App and Dashboard Building** — Helping clients build their own apps and dashboards on top of Foundry.
5. **Commercial Contract Management** — Managing client contracts, pricing, subscription renewals, and account relationships.
6. **Forward Deployed Engineering (FDE)** — Sending Palantir engineers into client organizations to deliver real results quickly.
7. **Commercial Billing and Invoicing** — Calculating and collecting payments from commercial clients.

6.3 AI and AIP Customers

1. **AIP Bootcamp Delivery** — Running 5-day workshops where customers build their first working AI use cases with Palantir engineers.
2. **LLM Integration** — Connecting AI language models securely to a client's data inside Foundry.
3. **AI Agent Development** — Helping clients build AI agents that automate tasks and trigger actions in their business processes.
4. **AI Governance Management** — Setting up processes for clients to test, audit, and control their AI workflows safely.
5. **AIP Customer Support** — Giving ongoing technical help and guidance to AIP clients after their deployment.
6. **AIP Use Case Scaling** — Helping clients expand from one working AI use case to many across different departments.

6.4 Developer and Partner Ecosystem

1. **Developer API and Platform Management** — Providing APIs, SDKs, and tools that allow third parties to build on Palantir platforms.
2. **Partner Onboarding and Certification** — Registering and certifying developer and system integrator partners.
3. **Developer Documentation and Support** — Writing and maintaining clear technical guides and a developer support portal.
4. **Partner Marketplace Management** — Running a marketplace where certified partners can list and sell their Palantir-based solutions.

5. **Partner Revenue and Billing Management** — Managing commercial agreements and revenue sharing with partner companies.

6.5 Healthcare and Life Sciences Customers

1. **Healthcare Data Integration** — Connecting hospital and clinical data to Foundry while fully following HIPAA and GDPR rules.
2. **Patient Flow and Clinical Operations** — Helping hospitals manage beds, patient scheduling, and care team workflows in real time.
3. **Pharma Supply Chain Management** — Tracking raw materials, production, and drug delivery from factory to pharmacy.
4. **Clinical Trial Data Management** — Managing complex data and regulatory reporting for pharmaceutical clinical trials.
5. **Public Health Emergency Response** — Helping health agencies track disease spread and manage emergency resources.
6. **Healthcare Regulatory Reporting** — Helping life sciences clients submit required reports to bodies like the FDA or EMA.

6.6 Internal Customers (Employees and Departments)

1. **Human Resource Management** — Managing all hiring, onboarding, performance reviews, and career development for Palantir staff.
2. **Payroll and Compensation** — Processing salaries, bonuses, equity, and benefits for all employees.
3. **Engineer Training and Development** — Providing technical training, platform certification, and leadership programs.
4. **Internal ICT Support** — Giving all staff the devices, software, and helpdesk support they need.
5. **Internal Finance and Budgeting** — Managing financial planning, budgets, and expense approvals for all departments.
6. **Legal and IP Affairs** — Handling intellectual property, contracts, litigation, and regulatory compliance internally.
7. **Marketing and Communications** — Managing Palantir's brand, PR, social media, and website.
8. **Procurement and Vendor Management** — Managing all cloud providers, software vendors, and third-party suppliers.

7. Case/Function Matrix with Processes

The table below shows 43 key Palantir processes — their focus, type, priority, and which case types they serve. X = process actively serves that case type.

Process / Business Function	Focus	Type	Priority	Govt	Comm.	AIP	Dev.	Health	Internal
Strategic Planning & Direction	Strategy	Management	High						X
Corporate Performance Monitoring	Strategy	Management	High						X
Risk & Compliance Management	Risk	Management	High						X
Finance, Audit & Control	Finance	Management	High						X
Portfolio & Investment Management	Strategy	Management	Medium						X
Gotham Platform Deployment	Gotham	Core	High	X					
Intelligence Data Fusion	Gotham	Core	High	X					
Mission Planning Support	Gotham	Core	High	X					
Government Contract Management	Govt Ops	Core	High	X					
Classified Network Deployment	Govt Ops	Core	High	X					
Defense Customer Training	Gotham	Core	High	X					
Govt Compliance Reporting	Govt Ops	Core	High	X					
Foundry Platform Deployment	Foundry	Core	High		X			X	
Data Pipeline Management	Foundry	Core	High	X	X			X	
Ontology & Data Model Development	Foundry	Core	High		X	X		X	
Custom App & Dashboard Building	Foundry	Core	High		X	X	X		
Commercial Contract Management	Comm Ops	Core	High		X			X	
Forward Deployed Engineering (FDE)	Deployment	Core	High	X	X	X		X	
Commercial Billing & Invoicing	Comm Ops	Core	High		X		X	X	
AIP Bootcamp Delivery	AIP	Core	High	X	X	X		X	
LLM Integration & Configuration	AIP	Core	High	X	X	X		X	

Process / Business Function	Focus	Type	Priority	Govt	Comm.	AIP	Dev.	Health	Internal
AI Agent Development	AIP	Core	High	X	X	X	X	X	
AI Governance Management	AIP	Core	High	X	X	X		X	
AIP Customer Support	AIP	Core	High		X	X		X	
AIP Use Case Scaling	AIP	Core	Medium	X	X	X		X	
Developer API & Platform Mgmt	Platform	Core	High				X		
Partner Onboarding & Certification	Ecosystem	Core	Medium				X		
Developer Docs & Support	Ecosystem	Core	Medium		X		X		
Partner Marketplace Management	Ecosystem	Core	Medium				X		
Partner Revenue & Billing	Ecosystem	Core	Medium				X		
Healthcare Data Integration	Healthcare	Core	High					X	
Patient Flow & Clinical Ops	Healthcare	Core	High					X	
Pharma Supply Chain Management	Healthcare	Core	High		X			X	
Clinical Trial Data Management	Healthcare	Core	High					X	
Public Health Emergency Response	Healthcare	Core	High	X				X	
Apollo SW Delivery & Deployment	Apollo	Core	High	X	X	X		X	
Multi-Environment Infrastructure	Apollo	Core	High	X	X				
Human Resource Management	HRM	Support	High						X
Payroll & Compensation	HRM	Support	High						X
Engineer Training & Development	HRM	Support	High						X
Internal ICT Support	ICT	Support	High						X
Internal Finance & Budgeting	Finance	Support	High						X
Legal & IP Affairs	Legal	Support	High						X
Marketing & Communications	Marketing	Support	Medium						X
Procurement & Vendor Management	Procurement	Support	Medium						X

Legend

Color / Type	Meaning
Management	Processes that plan, govern, and control Palantir — serve Internal Customers (leadership and board).
Core	Processes that deliver Palantir's platform products and services to all types of external customers.
Support	Processes that support the Core and Management layers — serve Internal Customers (employees and departments).

Note:

X = process actively serves that case type. Columns —

Govt = Government & Defense,

Comm. = Commercial Enterprise,

AIP = AI/AIP Customers,

Dev. = Developer & Partners,

Health = Healthcare & Life Sciences,

Internal = Palantir Employees & Departments.

8. Process Architecture

The Process Architecture shows how all of Palantir's business functions connect to its six case types. Instead of looking at it as layers, we read it as a grid — business functions are listed on the left side, and case types are listed across the top. Where a function serves a case type, a named process block is placed in that cell. This makes it easy to see which processes belong to which customers.

Case Types (Top of the Grid)

The five case types shown across the top of the grid are: Government and Defense, Commercial Enterprise, AIP and Developer, Healthcare and Life Sciences, and Internal Customers. Each column represents one customer group.

Business Functions (Left Side of the Grid)

The business functions in the grid are organized into four groups:

Platform Products — These are Palantir's four main software platforms: Gotham, Foundry, AIP, and Apollo. These are the core products that Palantir builds and delivers to its customers.

Customer Engagement — These are the functions that connect Palantir's teams with its customers: Client Onboarding, Forward Deployed Engineering (FDE), and Bootcamp Delivery. These make sure customers actually use the platforms and get real results.

Contract and Compliance — These are the administrative functions that keep the business running legally and financially: Government Contract Management, Regulatory Reporting, and Billing and Invoicing.

Support Functions — These are the internal functions that support Palantir's own staff: Human Resources, ICT and Infrastructure, Finance and Legal, and Marketing and Procurement.

Process Blocks (Pink Boxes in the Grid)

The pink boxes in the grid are the named processes. Each box shows which business functions are grouped into one process and which case type that process serves:

Government Operations — covers Platform Products and Customer Engagement rows under the Government and Defense column. This process handles everything related to deploying Gotham, training defense clients, and managing government customer engagement.

Commercial Foundry Ops — covers Foundry Platform, Client Onboarding, and Forward Deployed Engineering under the Commercial Enterprise column. This process handles delivering Foundry to business clients and making sure they are supported on-site.

AIP and Developer Services — covers AIP Platform, Forward Deployed Engineering, and Bootcamp Delivery under the AIP and Developer column. This process manages AI platform delivery, Bootcamp workshops, and developer partner support.

Healthcare Delivery — covers Foundry, AIP, FDE, and Bootcamp rows under the Healthcare and Life Sciences column. This process handles all Palantir work done for hospitals, pharmaceutical companies, and public health agencies.

Contract and Compliance — covers the Contract and Compliance rows under both Government and Commercial columns. This process manages all contract management, regulatory reporting, and billing for both government and commercial clients.

Internal Support — covers the Support Functions rows under the Internal Customers column. This process provides HR, ICT, finance, legal, and marketing services to Palantir's own employees and departments.

The diagram below shows the full process architecture grid for Palantir Technologies:

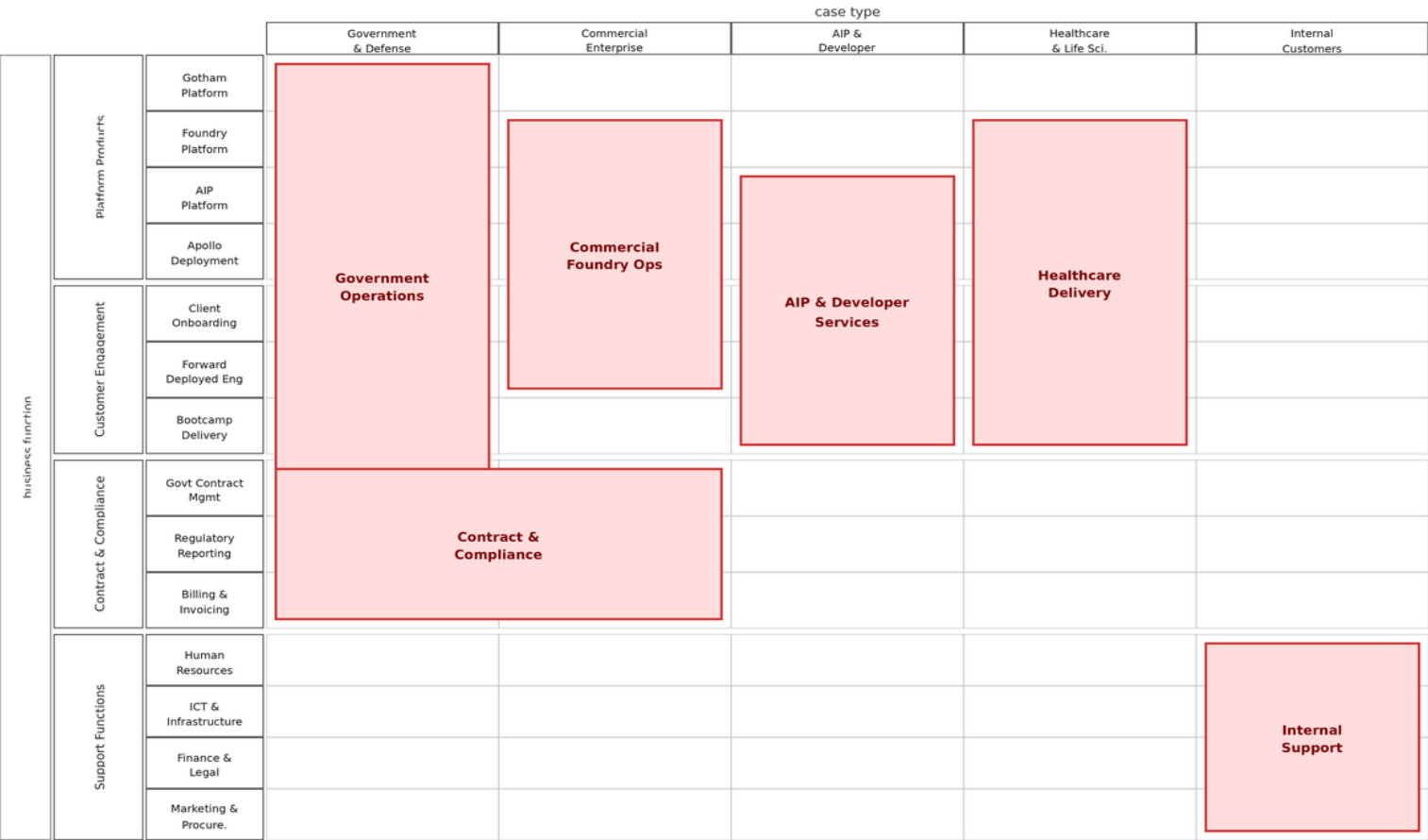


Fig. 1 A process architecture for Palantir Technologies

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